first agreed to in 1958 between Nehru and then Pakistani premier Firoz Khan Noon.

Indian leaders have coveted improved relations with Pakistan as their potential legacy. Given the record of discord and acrimony between the two neighbours, the idea of making history by resolving that conflict appeals to Indian politicians. Modi too started his tenure by reaching out to Pakistan, hoping to write a new chapter in the troubled India–Pakistan relationship. In December 2015, he made a short stopover in Lahore on his way back from Kabul to Delhi to meet with Pakistan's prime minister Nawaz Sharif. In a symbolic moment, Modi was photographed holding Sharif's hand, amid much fanfare reminiscent of Vajpayee's 1999 bus trip to Lahore.

The bonhomie ended with a terrorist attack on a military base at Pathankot, near the Pakistan border, in January 2016. A second terrorist attack on the Indian base at Uri in Kashmir in September 2016, which India blamed on Pakistan-sponsored jihadi groups, resulted in Modi's decision to break off talks with Pakistan without its concrete commitment to end support for terrorism. The 2016 SAARC summit, scheduled to be held in Islamabad, was cancelled after India (along with Afghanistan, Bangladesh and Bhutan) announced its boycott. India hinted at its desire to internationally isolate Pakistan in an effort to force policy changes over the terrorism issue. Indian special forces conducted what experts termed a 'surgical strike' aimed at terrorist camps across the Line of Control (LoC) in Pakistan-occupied Kashmir. This is not the first time that India had targeted terror camps inside Pakistan but this was the first time that the Indian government publicly announced such strikes.

Notwithstanding the setback in ties with Pakistan, Modi managed to forge closer relations with most of India's traditional friends around the world while adding some more to the list of global partners. In his first thirty-one months in office, Modi has travelled to forty-five countries including the United States, Japan, China, Australia, France, Germany and